

SketchUp

SketchUp is a powerful 3D modelling software that enables you to create, view, and modify 3D models. With simple, intuitive controls, you can push and pull your 3D objects to knock them into shape. You can use SketchUp for a variety of real-life projects—from adding an extension to your house to making a new widget. Drawings can be as simple or as detailed as you might want. You can use real-life dimensions to construct your model, as well as add colours and textures. SketchUp also simulates real-life shadows (showing you how shadows will fall when the sun falls on your model). To make getting started even simpler, there are thousands of pre-drawn components that will save you time—you don't have to start from scratch.

12.1 Installation And Basic Requirements

The software is available in two versions: SketchUp Pro, the paid version and Google SketchUp, the free version. For our purposes here, we will talk about basic uses of only the free version.

Download and install the latest version of Google SketchUp from <http://sketchup.google.com/download.html>. The software supports Windows 2000 / XP, and is also available for the Mac. There is no Linux version at present. Details of optimum system requirements are also on the same download page.

12.2 Learning SketchUp

The proficiency you achieve in using SketchUp will depend on how complex you want your 3D creations to be. The SketchUp Web site offers a wealth of training resources to help you get started.

For the beginner to 3D Modelling, an online user's guide is available, which will help get a grasp of the concepts and tech-